

Gautam Velpula

VP / Head of Enterprise Architecture & Platform Engineering

Digital Platforms • Payments • Cloud & Infrastructure • Greenfield Platform Delivery

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Executive Summary

Platform engineering leader with deep experience designing, building, and scaling greenfield digital platforms from the ground up. Proven track record delivering multi-tenant, microservices-based architectures on Azure and Kubernetes, integrating payment systems, and leading cross-functional engineering teams as a player-coach. Combines executive strategy with hands-on technical delivery to modernize legacy systems, architect cloud-native platforms, and drive operational excellence in high-availability, revenue-critical environments.

Professional Experience

GoTo Foods LLC

2021 – Present

Sr Director, Enterprise Architecture

- Led enterprise architecture and platform strategy for a multi-brand restaurant organization, serving as the single architectural authority across digital, payments, and data.
- Architected and delivered a **greenfield digital platform** from the ground up, completely rebuilding the legacy system into a modern, modular, multi-tenant architecture serving 7 brands.
- Built the **Kubernetes (AKS) infrastructure** the digital platform runs on, designing the container orchestration, deployment topology, and operational model.
- Designed the platform as a **microservices and event-driven architecture**, standardizing APIs, service contracts, and integration patterns to enable independent team velocity.
- Drove an **API-first strategy**, treating platform APIs as products — well-documented, versioned, and designed for rapid feature delivery by consumer app teams.
- Designed and led **payments integration with FreedomPay**, enabling digital wallets, tokenized transactions, and modern checkout experiences across brands.
- Architected and delivered a subscription service, including hands-on development of a stop-gap service to stabilize revenue during legacy system failures.
- Established **DevOps culture and CI/CD pipelines** for frequent, safe releases across the platform.
- Leading the design and implementation of **agentic AI use cases** across digital platforms, focused on automation, decision support, and operational efficiency.
- Driving enterprise adoption of **LLM-enabled development practices**, defining architectural patterns, guardrails, and best practices for safe and scalable usage.
- Reduced time-to-market by approximately 40% and improved system uptime by approximately 30%.
- Built and led a senior architecture organization as a **player-coach**, managing principal and lead architects while remaining hands-on during delivery.

Slalom Consulting
Senior Delivery Principal

2018 – 2021

- Served as senior delivery and advisory lead for complex, multi-million-dollar digital transformation, cloud modernization, and **payments platform** initiatives for Fortune 500 clients.
- Led cross-functional teams spanning engineering, architecture, product, and design across multi-year engagements.
- Conducted a multi-year **enterprise assessment of a legacy payments platform** for one of the largest eCommerce companies in the U.S., defining the target-state architecture and modernization roadmap.
- Led a major **cloud migration from on-premises and AWS to GCP** for a leading point-of-sale provider, demonstrating multi-cloud fluency.
- Designed and delivered **payment processing systems** for a large financial services organization, including settlement and compliance workflows.
- Implemented Agile and DevOps operating models, increasing deployment frequency by approximately 30% and reducing lead time by approximately 25%.
- Directed multiple multi-million-dollar engagements, achieving approximately 95% client satisfaction and repeat business.
- Mentored delivery leaders and principals, strengthening leadership depth and delivery maturity.

Jacada (acquired by Uniphore)
Director, Professional Services

2014 – 2018

- Owned global professional services delivery for enterprise customers, leading large-scale implementations for Fortune 500 clients.
- Held end-to-end accountability for delivery from pre-sales through post-implementation optimization.
- Led multi-year enterprise programs, delivering complex integrations and customizations in regulated environments.
- Acted as a trusted advisor to C-level stakeholders, aligning delivery with business objectives.
- Built and scaled a professional services organization through recruiting, training, and standardized delivery practices.

Technology Stack

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, Node.js, Java (Spring Boot), Go, NestJS, Next.js, React Native

Cloud & Infrastructure: Microsoft Azure (AKS, Front Door, API Management, Functions, Blob Storage), GCP, Kubernetes, Docker, Vercel, Cloudflare

Architecture: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, API-First Design, Multi-Tenant Platforms

Data & Messaging: Cosmos DB (MongoDB & PostgreSQL APIs), Databricks, Event Hub, Service Bus

Payments & Compliance: FreedomPay, Payment Gateway Integration, Digital Wallets, PCI-DSS

Observability: GA4, Firebase, Splunk

Core Strengths

Greenfield Platform Architecture • Payments & Fintech • Multi-Tenant Platform Design • Kubernetes & Cloud-Native Infrastructure • API Strategy • Player-Coach Leadership • DevOps & CI/CD • AI/LLM Adoption • Multi-Cloud Strategy

Education

Master of Science in Information Technology
George Mason University, Fairfax, VA

2007 – 2009

